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Original Page: [P. 190(A)]

Culture (OWC): [Bemba \(FQ05\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1930-1934

Coverage Date: Not Specified

Place Coverage: Zambia

Section Title(S): Untitled Section

It will be seen that as it exists at the present day, this system of opposite or complementary clans can hardly be described as a form of dual organization, since each *mukoa* is not systematically paired, but has often a number of different partners linked by the apparently arbitrary factor of the clan name. The man's and the woman's clans are separately paired, it is true, and each has no other *banungwe*, but the rain clan (*mfula*) counts as its opposite numbers all the clans with plant names (the millet clans, the gourd, the mushroom clans, the grass, the tree, etc.) since plants cannot grow without rain. The fish clan members are also *banungwe* to the rain people, since fish only spawn when the rain has begun to fall. The iron people reckon themselves *banungwe* to members of all clans with the names of animals hunted or killed with iron spears or arrows, *i.e.*, the elephant, lion, leopard, etc. The animal clans also have reciprocal relations not only with the iron people, but with any *mukoa* named after an animal smaller than itself which forms its prey (*e.g.*, the lion and goat) or with the vegetable names in the case of a herbivorous species (*e.g.*, elephant and grass, etc.). The members of the mourning clan laughingly assert they are *banungwe* of all the clans since they are experts in mortuary ritual! —one of the reciprocal functions performed by *banungwe* .

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What are the reciprocal functions the *banungwe* perform for each other? Their ceremonial duties are chiefly confined to funeral rites. ⁷ The *banungwe* of a dead man's family both help and harass him at the burial ceremony. When the mourner's party has set off with the corpse to the grave-yard a man and a woman of any of the opposite clans remain behind to whitewash the hut contaminated by the touch of death, and to open the door for the wailers as they return. This is an unpleasant duty since contact with death necessitates subsequent purification. It is, moreover, a task which cannot be performed by members of the dead man's own clan. When the burial is over and the

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question of inheritance [p. 190(b)] has finally been settled the *banungwe* are again essential. They have also to brew the beer for the feast held for the kinsmen on such occasions. Besides these necessary ritual functions which people perform for their *banungwe*, they also taunt them at the funeral, irritate them and make jokes. Some of the opposite clan members must follow the burial party to the grave. The moment the body has been buried and earth piled over it in a mound, one of the *banungwe* breaks the silence with a sudden shout. He rails at the mourning family, mocks at them, and accuses them of having buried a live man. He calls out, 'You, there! Why do you bury a man who is alive? Listen to him knocking down there! Can't you hear him? He is asking for some snuff. You enemies, you! (the usual term applied by *banungwe* to each other). See what things you do! You go and bury live men!' The taunts are, of course, expected, but were received, at each funeral I attended, with a kind of horrified silence, till suddenly the tension broke, and the mourners who had been wailing for some six hours without break, began sheepishly to laugh, and broke into an unceremonious run back to the village, still pursued by shouts from the irresponsible *banungwe*, 'Look out you now! He has risen (*Kubuka*) from the grave, that man you buried. He is coming after you asking for porridge.' ⁸ Older natives say that the mourners were beaten by their *banungwe* in the old days and add that the latter were also responsible for handing over to the heirs the insignia of inheritance—the bow of the dead man, or the belt of the woman—but I never saw either or these customs practised myself.

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It is interesting to note that the legends of origin of the Lamba *mukoa* usually refer to the behaviour of the clan ancestors on their return from a funeral. C. Doke, *op. cit.*, p. 193.

The word *kubuka* is that used for a dead man's spirit which returns to haunt the living (a *ciwa*).

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